Zahra Shahidi

PhD Candidate in Economics, York University

Email — LinkedIn — GitHub — Website

Education

2021–Present PhD in Economics, York University, Toronto

2016–2019 MSc in Economics, Institute for Management and Planning Studies (IMPS), Tehran

2010–2015 BSc in Mathematics and Applications, Iran University of Science and Technology, Tehran

Research Interests

Macroeconomics, Development, Growth, Gender and Inequality, Labor Economics

Job Market Paper

- *Information Frictions in Rural–Urban Migration* (with Tasso Adamopoulos). We combine panel data from Indonesia with a quantitative spatial model of imperfect information to study how localized social learning shapes migration. We find that information frictions account for about one-third of total migration costs and generate a welfare loss of 7 percent.

Working Paper

- *Misbeliefs and Education Decisions by Gender*. Developed a general-equilibrium education-choice model showing how gender differences in subjective beliefs about graduation contribute to enrollment decisions, dropout, talent misallocation, and wage outcomes.

Work in Progress

- *Spatial Patterns of Migration in Developing Countries (with Tasso Adamopoulos)*
- *Misallocation of Female Talent: The Puzzling Case of Iran*.

Publications

- *Liquidity Constraints and Durable/Non-durable Consumption Relationship in Iran*. *Journal of Planning and Budget*, 2020. (with Majid Einian and Seyed Ahmadreza Jalali-Naini)

Other Works & Published Reports

- *Analysis of Household Expenditures and Income Data 2019: Average Caloric Requirements of Iranian Households*. Parliament Research Center, 2020.
- *Poverty Monitoring Reports: Poverty Monitoring in 2020*. Ministry of Welfare & Parliament Research Center, 2021.

Research Experience

2023–Present Research Assistant, York University

- Conducted empirical research on development and migration
- Worked with IPUMS survey data in Stata and MATLAB to produce reports for academic research

2021 Researcher & Data Scientist, Ministry of Cooperatives, Labor, and Social Welfare, Tehran

- Conducted poverty and welfare analysis
- Developed coding pipelines in Stata and R for official reports

2019–2021 Researcher & Data Scientist, Parliament Research Center – Department of Economic Studies, Tehran

- Collaborated on projects examining poverty and inequality using large-scale household survey data
- Prepared official poverty monitoring reports

2018–2019 Research Assistant, Tehran Municipality

- Assisted in transportation research and data preparation

Teaching Experience

2021–Present Teaching Assistant, York University

- Supported undergraduate and graduate economics courses
- Guided students in coursework and assignments

Fellowships & Awards

2024–2025 Dissertation Fieldwork Fellowship, York University

2010–2019 Fully Funded Scholarship, BSc at Iran University of Science and Technology; MSc at IMPS

Academic Service

2024–Present Vice President, Economics Graduate Students Association (EGSA), York University

Technical Skills

Stata, MATLAB, R, Python, SQL, GitHub, EViews, LaTeX